31. See esp. Ball 2019: No. 149 for elevations of the partly underground structure. As we have seen in Chapters 2–4, pre-modern textual sources were less than specific about the structures encountered on military campaigns – and in the case of the Ghaznavid campaigns, formulaic mentions of "idol-breaking" occluded rather than laid bare the details of engagement with the built environment.
32. Cf. Patel 2004: 54 and n. 24, 108–109, pls. 44–45.
33. For early stepwells in Gujarat – an area that had been pivotal for both Mahmud Ghaznavi in AH 416/1025 CE, and Mu'izz al-Din about 150 years later (cf. Chapter 6), see, *inter alia*, Jain-Neubauer 1981: 19–21 (and figs.). A parallel *numismatic* example of cultural practices moving west from the Indian subcontinent are *jital*s, one minted with the stamp of Nimruz: the location of the mint remains ambiguous, however, as the term denoted a region rather than a specific place as of the eleventh century; meanwhile, the city name of Zaranj was replaced by *shahr-i Sijistān* by the tenth century, even as *Nimruz* continued to be a region. By the thirteenth–fourteenth centuries, *Nimruz* had come to replace *shahr-i Sijistan* as a mint name. Thus, the question remains whether *Nimruz* and *shahr-i Sijistan* were effectively the names for Zaranj, changing over time (Bosworth 1994: 37, 367, 426, 441). Although Nimruz/Sistan was considered "the most westerly mint to adopt the jital" (R. and M. Tye 1995: 50 and Nos. 123, 124), O'Neal (pers. comm., July 2020) concluded that another example with the mint name of Marv would indicate the slightly farther western and also northern reach of the *jital* type. Cf. Nicol 2005: 176; and Volume II.
34. The ambiguity of the structure's *raison d'être* cannot be clarified by the remnant of the construction text, which followed the Qur'anic inscription(s) on the left side of the arch's east face (cf. *infra* in main text, and notes). Although this fragmentary text contained the expected phrase "… (he who) brought to completion this … in the year …," the referent for the definite article was unclear, except possibly a final *ta marbuta*. Sourdel-Thomine's (1978: 65) suggestion of *qubba* would certainly imply a memorial function for this arch, but she proposed this reading as tenuous. See Appendix, Afghanistan II.
35. Sourdel-Thomine (1978: 63) had assumed that the arch formed the entrance to a large building. After re-surveying the site, however, Allen (1988: 59–60, fig. 2) proposed that the arch could not have been a building entrance: not only were both faces of the arch decorated; additionally, insufficient space around the extant monument made it impossible for a mosque of commensurate proportions to have been constructed there. See also Ball and Fischer 2019: 474.
36. The publication (Sourdel-Thomine 1978: 64–65) notes Q. II: 121 as the cited verse; upon verifying the epigraphy and the author's translation, however, the correct citation would be Q. II: 127 – surely a simple typographical error.
37. Sourdel-Thomine 1978: 66.
38. Allen 1988: 59–60.
39. Blair 1992. The verses have been recorded at Qasr Kharana, Jordan and dated AH 92/710 CE; and on the minaret of Aleppo's *jami'* in floriated Kufic, datable to AH 483/1090 CE (the verses' *naskh* rendition on Delhi's 'Ala'-i Darwaza is